THE GAP

A 90-day rite of passage. Bridging the distance between who the world tells you to be and who you actually are.

90	3	3	1
DAYS	COUNTRIES	PHASES	QUESTION

"School gave you a story about yourself. Society reinforced it. Your feed, your peers, your family — all of it built a version of you that may have nothing to do with who you are underneath all that noise. THE GAP is 90 days to find out."

PROGRAM OVERVIEW

90 Days.
Three Phases.

This is not a gap year. It is not a vacation. It is not a program.
It is the thing that should have happened before you were handed a life you didn't choose.

Every culture that understood something about human development had a rite of passage — a moment where a young person was sent into difficulty and returned as themselves. We don't have that anymore. We have resume builders and Instagram trips. THE GAP is what should have existed.

AT A GLANCE

DAYS	PHASE	LOCATION	FOCUS	KEY EXPERIENCES
1–30	**Phase 1: Decondition**	New Zealand	Strip the noise. Find the signal.	Wilderness, Maori, Bungee, Skydive, Muay Thai prep
29–57	**Phase 2: Encounter**	Bali + Thailand	Meet people who chose themselves.	Freediving, breathwork, Muay Thai 2-week camp
58–90	**Phase 3: Return**	Colombia + Costa Rica	Give it back. Build the school.	Service, Amazon, 7-day prototype program

THE THREE PHASES

PHASE ONE · NZ

Decondition

The world has been building a version of you for twenty years. Physical challenge, cold water, distance, and silence dismantle it — not with therapy, but with presence. You cannot maintain a false self when your nervous system is fully occupied being alive.

PHASE TWO · SE ASIA

Encounter

You will meet people who chose themselves. Masters. Warriors. Watermen. People who look nothing like what society rewards and everything like what a real life looks like. You learn not by taking notes but by moving alongside them.

PHASE THREE · LATAM

Return

Everything you found gets given back. You don't return as the same person — you return as the real one. And the real one leads. The real one shows others the door. This is where the program becomes something larger than itself.

DAILY STANDARDS

The Non-Negotiables

These happen every single day of 90 days. No exceptions. No rest days. Miss them and you're just traveling.

01 — Every Morning

COLD EXPOSURE

Ocean, river, cold shower — before anything else. Not about health. About choosing to do something hard before the world has asked anything of you. It rewires what you think is possible before breakfast.

02 — Every Morning

MORNING PAGES

3 pages, handwritten, before touching your phone. Not a journal — a brain dump. Let every thought out. Most people have never met their own mind. This is how.

03 — Every Week

THE WEEK'S QUESTION

One question per week. Don't answer it on Day 1 — live inside it. Carry it through every experience. By Day 7 it will have answered itself in ways you couldn't have predicted.

04 — Every Day

4 HOURS PHONE-FREE

Awake, present, unreachable. The phone is the primary mechanism through which the false self maintains itself. Remove the feed and see what's left.

05 — Every Day

ONE REAL CONVERSATION

Not "where are you from." Ask something that matters. "What's the best decision you ever made?" "What do you know now you wish you'd known at 20?" The world is full of people with answers you haven't thought to seek.

06 — Every Evening

EVENING WRITE

20–30 minutes responding to the week's question. Don't try to answer it — write what the day stirred up. Over 90 days, this becomes the most honest document you will ever create about yourself.

DAILY STRUCTURE

The Daily Rhythm

This schedule adapts to every location and activity — but the structure holds everywhere. The rhythm is what makes you feel like yourself when you get home.

05:30	**Wake**	Phone stays face-down. No exceptions. The morning belongs to you before anyone else.
05:45	**Cold Exposure**	Ocean, river, or cold shower. Get in. Stay until the urge to get out passes. That moment is what everything is built on.
06:15	**Morning Pages**	3 pages, pen and paper, no editing, no stopping. Excavation, not journaling.
07:00	**Movement**	Run, swim, hike, or train. Minimum 45 minutes. Push into uncomfortable territory.
09:00	**Breakfast**	Eat with people when possible. Slowly. Food is one of the oldest forms of human connection.
10:00	**Main Block**	Primary experience — training, expedition, service, exploration. This is where the program lives.
13:00	**Rest (90 min)**	Non-negotiable. Rest is when transformation actually happens. Protect it.
14:30	**Secondary Block**	Secondary activity, mentorship encounter, or free exploration.
17:30	**Solo Hour**	Walk, swim, or sit somewhere alone. No headphones. No phone. Most important hour of every day. This is where it all integrates.
18:30	**Dinner**	Present. With people when possible.
20:00	**Evening Write**	20–30 minutes. What did today stir up?
21:30	**Read**	Physical book only. The discipline of sustained attention is its own practice.
22:30	**Sleep**	

MONTH ONE · DAYS 1–28 · PHASE 1: DECONDITION

New Zealand

South Island · Northland Bay of Islands · Queenstown · West Coast

> *"Who are you when you strip away everything you were told to be?"*

DURATION	PHASE	PRIMARY THEME	SERVICE MOMENT
28 Days	Decondition	Silence, Physical Challenge, Identity	Maori Youth Outdoor Program

WEEK 1 The Silence

"What stories am I carrying that I didn't choose?"

DAY 01

Auckland → Remote South Island Bach

ARRIVAL

ARRIVAL — INTO THE QUIET

MORNING / TRANSIT

Land Auckland. No city. Pick up rental car, drive south immediately to a remote bach — a NZ cabin, no neighbors, no wifi. This is your first 24 hours. Arrive before dark.

AFTERNOON

Unpack slowly. Walk the property. Find water — river, beach, or stream. Go in. First cold exposure. Stay in until your mind stops arguing with your body. That gap between mind and body is the entire territory of this program.

EVENING

One hour writing: not about the trip — about who you were the day before you left. Write it like a character study. Get specific: how did you talk, what did you perform, what were you afraid people would find out?

> THE PURPOSE
>
> *You can't find yourself by jumping straight into stimulation. The first act is to put distance — real distance — between you and everything that was telling you who to be.*

DAY 02

Remote Bach

REFLECTION

FIRST SILENCE — MEETING YOUR OWN MIND

MORNING

Cold exposure. Morning pages. Then 2-hour walk with no destination, no headphones. When you feel the urge to check your phone, notice it and don't. That urge is information. What are you trying to avoid?

AFTERNOON

Sit outside for one hour doing nothing. Not meditating — just sitting. Notice what your mind does when you don't give it a task. Most people have never done this. It will be uncomfortable. It is supposed to be.

EVENING WRITE

"What do I actually think about when I have nothing to think about?"

DAY 03

South Island Trails

MOVEMENT

THE RUN + THE RIDGE

MORNING

Cold exposure. Pages. Run — no distance target, no tracking. Run until your body finds its rhythm and your mind goes quiet. The run is not the exercise. The quiet mind is the destination.

MAIN BLOCK

6-hour solo hike on a remote trail. No headphones. Stop whenever the view demands it. Notice what thoughts rise when there is nothing to fill the silence.

EVENING WRITE

"When was the last time I felt completely myself? Where? Who was I with? What made that moment different?"

DAY 04

Routeburn Track — Overnight

OVERNIGHT

OVERNIGHT ON THE TRACK — WHO ARE YOU IN THE DARK?

FULL DAY

Pack for overnight. Walk 8–10 hours solo on the Routeburn Track. Camp overnight. No phone signal. The southern sky is visible here in a way that physically stops you.

THE PRINCIPLE

When your body is working hard to cover ground, the mind doesn't have bandwidth for performance. Notice who you are when that is all you are — just a body moving through landscape.

EVENING WRITE (BY HEADLAMP)

"What did I stop performing today? What was underneath it?"

> THE PURPOSE
>
> *The overnight is the first real test. You cannot maintain an image in a tent in the dark. Whatever shows up alone on a mountain at night is the real material.*

DAY 05

West Coast Tasman Sea

COLD WATER

THE TASMAN SEA — IT DOESN'T CARE WHO YOU ARE

MORNING

Break camp. Walk out. If the trail crosses a river — go in, don't go around.

AFTERNOON

Drive to the west coast. The Tasman Sea is wild, largely empty, and cold. Find where the waves hit. Go in. The sea doesn't care who you are. That's the entire point.

EVENING WRITE

"What has school actually taught me about who I am? How much of it is real? How much was someone else's story?"

DAY 06

Nearest Town

ENCOUNTER

FIND A HUMAN — ONE REAL CONVERSATION

FULL DAY

Rest day. Find a local café or pub. Sit for two hours with a physical book. When someone sits near you — talk to them. Not to perform. Just to listen. Ask something real. Let them surprise you.

THE RULE

Ask something that matters: "What do you love about living here?" "What's the best thing you know?" You are looking for people with answers to questions you haven't thought to ask.

EVENING WRITE

Write specifically what the stranger showed you. Not what you talked about — what you learned.

DAY 07

South Island

DEBRIEF

WEEK ONE DEBRIEF — MAP THE DISTANCE

MORNING

Cold exposure. Pages. Re-read everything you wrote this week — all of it. Slowly. Circle anything that surprised you, contradicted what you expected, or felt more true than you were ready for.

AFTERNOON

These circles are data points. You are mapping the distance between who you thought you were and who you actually are. That map is the purpose of this entire month.

WEEK SUMMARY

"Three things I thought were true about myself that I'm not sure about anymore."

WEEK 2 Maori + Water

"What does it mean to belong — to a place, a people, yourself?"

DAY 08

South Island → Northland

TRANSIT

DRIVE NORTH — INTO THE ORIGINAL

TRAVEL DAY

Head to Northland — the oldest part of New Zealand, the heartland of Maori culture. This is not tourist New Zealand. Drive slowly. Stop when something calls you. Arrive by evening.

THE SHIFT

You're leaving the landscape of silence and entering the landscape of encounter. The first week stripped you. This week shows you what can exist in that space.

EVENING WRITE

"What does it feel like to arrive somewhere that has been home to people for a thousand years before you?"

DAY 09

Waipoua Forest, Northland

ENCOUNTER

WAIPOUA FOREST — WHAKAPAPA

FULL DAY

Spend the day with a Maori guide in Waipoua Forest — home to kauri trees 2,000 years old. Your guide teaches you about whakapapa: you are not just yourself. You are all the people who came before you. You carry your ancestors in your body. You exist in a line, not in isolation.

THE TENSION

The western concept: you are an individual. Whakapapa: you are a continuation. Both are true. Before you can find yourself, you need to understand what "self" actually means. The Maori answer is radically different from what school taught you.

EVENING WRITE

"Who came before me that I carry without knowing? What did they give me? What did they put in me that I didn't choose?"

DAY 10

Bay of Islands

WATER

OPEN WATER KAYAK + REEF SNORKEL

MORNING

Kayak Bay of Islands — 4 hours open water between islands. Not a tour. Just you and the water. Your arms will give out before your mind does. When they do — stop thinking about the paddle. Just move. Switch from managing to being.

AFTERNOON

Snorkel the reef for one hour. Underwater, the world is silent. Notice what changes in you when the noise disappears completely.

EVENING WRITE

"What does my body know about me that my mind doesn't?"

DAY 11

Northland

SERVICE

MAORI YOUTH PROGRAM — FIRST TIME AS GUIDE

FULL DAY

Arranged in advance: spend the day with a Maori youth outdoor program. You are not volunteering. You are not saving anyone. You are showing up. Run a 45-minute morning movement session: stretching, breathing, a short trail. Keep it simple.

THE SERVICE RULE

What matters is not the activity — it is the quality of your presence. Be fully there. Afternoon: move alongside them. Play. Get competitive. Let them beat you at things.

EVENING WRITE

"What changed in me when I was responsible for someone else's experience? What does guiding actually feel like?"

SERVICE PRINCIPLE

The service in this program is never about charity. It is about showing up and being fully present with other human beings. These kids don't need your help — they need your presence. There is a difference. Learn it here first.

DAY 12

West Northland Coast

WATER

LEARN TO SURF — FALL WITHOUT EGO

FULL DAY

Surf lesson on the west coast. Day 1. Fall many times. The falling is the lesson. Notice how falling in water has zero ego attached. You fall, laugh, paddle back. The ocean doesn't remember your falls.

THE INSIGHT

Notice how different this is from failing in life — where every mistake feels permanent and public. What would you try if failure felt like this instead?

EVENING WRITE

"What would I try if I wasn't afraid of being seen failing?"

DAY 13

West Northland Coast

WATER

SURF ALONE + FIND YOUR OBJECT

MORNING

Surf on your own. No instructor. 3 hours in the water. Eat on the beach. Go back in. The second session is when the real learning happens — when you're tired and the ego has given up trying to look good.

AFTERNOON

Long beach walk — no phone. Find something: a rock, a shell, a piece of driftwood. Something that represents who you were before this trip. Keep it for all 90 days. You'll know what to do with it at the end.

EVENING WRITE

"What does the ocean ask of me that normal life doesn't?"

DAY 14

Bay of Islands

DEBRIEF

WEEK TWO DEBRIEF + LETTER

MORNING

Re-read the week's writing. The week's question was about belonging. Write your actual answer — not the right answer, but what the week showed you through the water, the forest, the guide, and the kids.

AFTERNOON

Rest. Cook a proper meal. Eat slowly. Let the week land.

EVENING WRITE

Write a letter to someone at home. Tell them something true about yourself you've never said out loud. You don't have to send it. Write it as if you will.

WEEK 3

Queenstown — Adrenaline as Truth Serum

"When does the performance disappear?"

> *Adrenaline is not entertainment. It is a neurological reset. In the three seconds before you jump, your mind cannot maintain a story about who you are. The social masks dissolve. Only the real you exists there. This week uses adrenaline as an instrument for truth.*

DAY 15

Queenstown

ARRIVAL

ARRIVAL — PREPARE THE MIND

AFTERNOON

Arrive Queenstown. Walk the lakefront for one hour without your phone. This town will try to sell you experiences. You are not here to buy them. You are here to use them as instruments.

EVENING

Light meal. Early sleep. Prepare mentally. Tomorrow is real.

EVENING WRITE

"When was the last time I was genuinely afraid — not anxious, but actually afraid? What did it feel like? Who was I in that moment?"

DAY 16

Kawarau Bridge

ADRENALINE

THE BUNGEE — AJ HACKETT KAWARAU BRIDGE (43M)

THE EXPERIENCE

The original bungee. 43 meters. Before the platform, notice your breathing. On the platform, notice what your brain says — it will offer thousands of reasons not to jump. Notice none of them are real. The moment you stop arguing and just go is one of the most honest experiences available to a human being.

IMMEDIATE PROTOCOL

After landing — before talking to anyone — find somewhere quiet and write for 20 minutes. Every sensation. Every thought. What happened in the 3 seconds before you jumped? Who were you in that moment?

EVENING WRITE

"What parts of my daily life am I hesitating at the edge of? What is the equivalent of the platform? What is the equivalent of just going?"

> THE PURPOSE
>
> *You cannot perform in that moment. Only the real you exists at the edge. The write immediately after is the entire point — capture who that person was before the rational mind reclaims the experience.*

DAY 17

Shotover River

ADRENALINE

SHOTOVER RIVER WHITEWATER — WHO ARE YOU UNDER PRESSURE?

FULL DAY

Class IV whitewater with strangers. This is different from the bungee — it's a team experience. You and a river that does not care about your feelings. Notice how you move with others under real pressure. Do you lead? Freeze? Become more yourself or less?

OBSERVATION

No judgment — only observation. The ring shows you what the classroom hides. Your behavior under low-stakes pressure is a preview of who you are under high-stakes pressure.

EVENING WRITE

"Who am I in a team under pressure? What did I do that surprised me? What did I wish I'd done differently?"

DAY 18

15,000 ft, Queenstown

ADRENALINE

THE SKYDIVE — 60 SECONDS OF COMPLETE PRESENCE

THE EXPERIENCE

15,000 feet, tandem. The plane ride is 20 minutes of sitting with pure anticipatory fear. Don't manage it. Don't perform calm. Let it be there. Freefall: 60 seconds at 200km/h. In freefall, there is no past and no future. Only the present moment. Most people spend their entire lives slightly behind or ahead of now. This is fully here.

IMMEDIATE PROTOCOL

After landing: 3 pages immediately. What happened to you up there? What was freefall like in your body? And — the most important question — when else in your life do you feel that present? If the answer is "never," that is the most important thing this program will ever show you.

EVENING WRITE

"What would my life look like if I lived at the level of presence I felt in freefall?"

DAY 19

Skippers Canyon · Remarkables

ADRENALINE

CANYON SWING + VIA FERRATA — BODY AS PROBLEM-SOLVER

MORNING

Canyon Swing — 60-meter free-fall before the swing catches. You choose your jump position: forwards, backwards, seated. The choice itself is the lesson. Total agency. The mind fights every option. Choose anyway.

AFTERNOON

Via ferrata climbing in the Remarkables — technical movement on a real cliff face. Physical problem-solving in vertical terrain. Your body knows what to do if your mind stays quiet.

EVENING WRITE

"What is the relationship between my mind and my body? When do they work together? When does my mind get in my body's way?"

DAY 20

Queenstown Hill

SOLO

SOLO MOUNTAIN — BE SOMEWHERE YOU EARNED

MORNING

Queenstown Hill Track — 2 hours to the summit. Solo. Slow. No music. Sit at the top for 45 minutes. Do not photograph it. Do not post it. Just be somewhere you earned with your body. This is the counterweight to the week's adrenaline — the earned stillness.

AFTERNOON

Find a quiet place by the lake. Write for 2 hours. Mid-program reflection: What has this week changed? What did the adrenaline show you? What is the common thread across every experience?

EVENING

Rest. Cook a real meal. Eat slowly. Sleep early. Let this week integrate.

DAY 21

Queenstown

DEBRIEF

WEEK THREE DEBRIEF — THE LETTER

FULL DAY

Re-read the week's writing. Synthesis: "The week's question was about when the performed self disappears. What did I find? What does my real self actually feel like?"

WEEK LETTER

Write a letter from the version of you at the top of Queenstown Hill to the version of you who arrived in New Zealand 3 weeks ago. What do you want him to know?

PREPARATION

Begin preparing for travel to the West Coast and departure. Gear check. Clean and organize everything. Respect the logistics.

WEEK 4 West Coast + Departure

"What am I leaving behind? What am I taking?"

DAYS 22–24

Westland · Milford Sound

WILD

GLACIERS, WILD SWIMMING, MILFORD SOUND

DAY 22 — GLACIERS

Fox Glacier hike — ice underfoot, blue crevasses, the sound of melt water. These glaciers are disappearing. Walk on something irreplaceable and feel the weight of that. Ask: what in my own life is disappearing that I'm pretending isn't?

DAY 23 — WILD SWIMMING

Drive the West Coast highway south. Stop at every blue river you cross. Swim in all of them. The cold water forces you into your body, into this moment, this river — away from everything behind you and ahead.

DAY 24 — MILFORD SOUND

Paddle Milford Sound by kayak — waterfalls into the water, seals on the rocks, fiords so deep the water is black. One of the most beautiful places on earth. Be fully in it. See it with your actual eyes.

DAY 25

Wherever You Are

THE LETTER

MONTH ONE LETTER — SEAL IT UNTIL DAY 85

FULL DAY — WRITING ONLY

You do not leave the room today except for cold exposure and your solo hour. Write your Month 1 letter to yourself. Minimum 4 pages.

ANSWER THESE

Who did I arrive as? · Who am I leaving as? · What died this month? · What was born? · What do I know now that I didn't know 25 days ago? · What do I want to tell myself in Month 3?

INSTRUCTION

Seal in an envelope. Write "OPEN ON DAY 85" on the outside. This travels with you to every country. You will not break the seal early.

THE PURPOSE

On Day 85, reading who wrote this letter and feeling the distance between that person and who is reading it will be one of the most important moments of the 90 days. Don't rob yourself of it.

DAYS 26–28

Auckland → Bali

TRANSIT

FINAL DAY IN NZ + TRAVEL TO BALI

DAY 26

Cold ocean one last time. Walk the shore. Leave something behind — genuine thanks to the country that showed you the first version of yourself. Clean up a beach. Help someone who needs it. Leave it better than you found it.

DAYS 27–28

Long-haul to Bali. Don't watch movies the whole way. Read. Write. Sleep. Let the distance between New Zealand and your destination be real. You are not the same person who landed in Auckland.

ARRIVE

Head directly to Amed, East Bali — black volcanic sand, quiet, the Bali most tourists never find. Do not go to Kuta.

MONTH TWO · DAYS 29–57 · PHASE 2: ENCOUNTER

Bali + Thailand

Amed · Ubud · Uluwatu · Chiang Mai

> *"What can your body do that your mind said was impossible? What do people look like when they've fully chosen themselves?"*

DURATION	PHASE	PRIMARY THEME	CAPSTONE
29 Days	Encounter	Stillness + Fire. Water + Combat.	Muay Thai Optional Bout

WEEKS 5–6

Bali — Stillness

"What does it feel like to be completely still inside a moving world?"

DAYS 30–32

Amed, East Bali

FREEDIVING

AIDA FREEDIVING COURSE — THE QUIETEST PLACE

DAY 30 — THEORY + POOL

Begin AIDA Level 2 freediving. Theory: how breathing actually works, full diaphragmatic breath, breath-hold physiology. Your lungs have twice the capacity you normally use. You will learn that the ocean rewards stillness. So does life. School never taught you how to cultivate it.

DAY 31 — FIRST REAL DIVES

Open water, 10 meters on a single breath. Under the surface: no sound except your own heartbeat. No past. No future. Just pressure, water, and faint blue light above you. The quietest place you will ever go. Some people cry after the first real freedive — not from fear, from relief.

DAY 32 — CERTIFICATION

AIDA cert dives — 16-meter target depth. You are doing something today on a single breath that your mind said was impossible when you started. Every time the mind says "I can't," this dive is the evidence that the mind is a liar.

> THE PURPOSE
>
> *Freediving teaches that stillness is a skill. The body's panic reflex is a story the mind tells, not a physical reality. What else in your life has your mind labeled "impossible" that your body could handle if you let it?*

DAYS 33–34

Amed, Family Compound

HOMESTAY

BALINESE FAMILY HOMESTAY — DAILY OFFERING

THE SETUP

This is not a hotel. You eat with the family, help cook, sit in the compound in the evenings. The Balinese make offerings every single morning — small baskets of flowers and incense at every doorway, altar, corner. Before they do anything for themselves, they acknowledge the world.

DAY 34

Help prepare the morning offerings. Move with the family's rhythm. Eat what they eat. Help where you can. Afternoon: find the local kids. Play — football, swimming, anything. Children who haven't been told who they are yet play with everything they have. Watch that. Remember it.

EVENING WRITE

"What would it mean to live with this level of presence in my ordinary life? What am I rushing past?"

DAY 35

Ubud

BREATHWORK

WIM HOF BREATHWORK — POWER IS INTERNAL

MORNING

Wim Hof breathwork session with a practitioner. Not a yoga class. You will breathe in ways that produce physiological states you cannot achieve otherwise — tingling, pressure, emotion, sometimes visions. Strange and real. Let whatever comes up, come up.

THE CORE LESSON

You can change how you feel from the inside. You have been waiting for the outside world to make you feel okay — the right circumstances, relationship, achievement. This practice shows you the power was always internal. It has always been yours.

EVENING WRITE

"What did the breathwork stir up? What am I carrying in my body that I haven't addressed?"

DAY 36

Uluwatu

SACRED

ULUWATU — THE TEMPLE AND THE WAVE

PRE-DAWN

Drive to Uluwatu before sunrise — 5:30 AM. Cold ocean. Morning pages on the cliff.

DAWN SURF

Surf Uluwatu at first light. A 1,000-year-old Hindu temple sits on the cliff above. Below it, the Indian Ocean delivers some of the most consistent surf in the world. The temple and the surf are not in conflict — they are the same thing. The offering and the wave. Sacred and physical are not opposites. This is the core teaching Bali has been building toward.

EVENING WRITE

"What does beauty do to the false self? What happens to the performance when you're in the presence of something genuinely larger than you?"

DAY 37

Amed · Blue Lagoon

SERVICE

REEF CLEANUP + CLIFF JUMPING

MORNING — SERVICE

Join a reef cleanup dive with local dive shops in Amed. You are a guest in this ocean. The ocean gave you your most important experiences this week. Give something back. Two hours underwater with local divers removing what doesn't belong.

AFTERNOON — JOY

Cliff jumping at Blue Lagoon. Pure joy. No symbolism. No framework. Just jumping because you are alive and that is enough. This matters too.

EVENING WRITE

"What does pure joy feel like separate from achievement? When do I let myself just enjoy being alive?"

DAYS 38–40

Munduk · Bali

ENCOUNTER

MUNDUK MOUNTAINS + BALI INTEGRATION

DAY 38 — MUNDUK

Mountain interior of Bali — mist, waterfalls, rice terraces farmed for a thousand years. Find an elder in the village. Buy them tea. Ask: "What do you know now that you wish you'd known at my age?" Listen only. Take no notes. Write what they said from memory in the evening.

DAY 39 — COOKING + SERVICE

Cook with a local family in their home — not a tourist school. Then bring a football to a local school. No agenda. Just play with whoever wants to play. Service as presence, not performance.

DAY 40 — INTEGRATION

No activities. Write the Bali chapter: what did the water teach you, the stillness, the family, the breathwork? Pack. Tomorrow: Thailand.

WEEKS 7–8

Muay Thai Camp, Thailand — Fire

"What do I do when I am afraid and I cannot run?"

> *You cannot grow in the presence of comfort. In the ring — even sparring lightly — every social mask you wear falls away. You cannot perform toughness when someone can actually hit you. What remains is real. This is not about becoming a fighter. It is about two weeks in the presence of something that requires your complete and total honesty.*

DAY 41

Chiang Mai, Thailand

ARRIVAL

ARRIVE AT CAMP — OBSERVE FIRST

CAMP SELECTION

Check into a real Muay Thai camp — Sinbi, Sitsongpeenong, Tiger Muay Thai, or Lanna. Not a tourist operation. A real camp with real fighters. Meet your trainers. Watch the evening session without joining.

OBSERVATION

Notice how the fighters move — like they have made absolute peace with their bodies. That kind of relationship with your own body is what this two weeks is building. Tomorrow you begin.

EVENING WRITE

"What is my relationship with physical discomfort? Do I run toward it or away from it? What does that tell me about who I am?"

DAYS 42–56

Muay Thai Camp, Chiang Mai

TRAINING

14-DAY CAMP — THE FULL SCHEDULE

DAILY TRAINING SCHEDULE (EVERY DAY, NO EXCEPTIONS)

06:00 AM	5km run
06:30 AM	Shadow boxing — 3 rounds
07:00 AM	Heavy bag — 5 rounds
07:30 AM	Pad work with trainer — 5 rounds
08:15 AM	Conditioning — 200 sit-ups, 200 push-ups, skip
11:30 AM	Rest — mandatory. Sleep, eat, hydrate.
04:00 PM	Technique + clinch + sparring — 2 hours
Evening	Write one moment from training. Not a recap — one specific moment.

DAYS 1–3: SHOCK

Your body revolts. Everything hurts. Trainers show you no mercy — not because they don't care, because they see what you can do and refuse to settle for less. Train anyway.

DAYS 4–6: THE WALL

Almost everyone wants to quit. Novelty has worn off. Soreness has peaked. Skill isn't there yet. This is the exact moment the program is built around. Choosing to stay is when you begin to meet yourself.

DAYS 7–14: INSIDE IT

Day 7 — something shifts. You stop thinking and start moving. The trainer nods once. Day 10: write specifically — "Who was I on Day 1? Who am I now? What can I do with my body that I couldn't ten days ago?"

SPARRING PROTOCOL

The first time another person's glove touches your face, the part of your brain that manages your public image goes offline. You stop thinking about how you look. You respond. Who you are in that response — without the filter — is the most honest data point this program offers.

DAY 47

Doi Inthanon NP

REST DAY

DOI INTHANON — THE DIRT AND THE VIEW

FULL DAY

Thailand's highest peak. Hike it. Cool at the summit — a gift after a week of heat and sweat. Walk slowly. You need both: the dirt of the camp and the view from above it. One without the other is incomplete.

REFLECTION

What does the past week look like from here? What have you learned that you couldn't see while you were in it?

EVENING WRITE

"What does the past week look like from a distance? What have I learned that I couldn't see while I was in it?"

DAY 53

Muay Thai Camp

SERVICE

TEACHING THE YOUNG ONES — YOU ARE THE GUIDE NOW

AFTERNOON

Most camps have local kids training. Spend 2 hours working with the youngest ones — holding pads, teaching footwork, being present. You learned this 11 days ago. Already you can show someone else. Notice: you have become the guide. This will keep happening.

ENCOUNTER

Ask your trainer about their life. Where did they come from? Why Muay Thai? What has it taught them? This person has built a life around a discipline. What does that look like from the inside?

EVENING WRITE

"What does teaching show me about how much I've actually learned?"

SERVICE MOMENT

Some of these kids have nothing except the discipline this camp gives them. They train with everything. You've been training to find yourself. They train because it's the best thing in their world. Let that recalibrate your relationship to why you're here.

DAY 55

Muay Thai Camp

OPTIONAL FIGHT

OPTIONAL FIGHT — WALK INTO THE RING

WHITE COLLAR BOUT

Most camps offer an amateur fight at the end of a 2-week camp. Do it. You do not need to win. You need to know what it feels like to walk into a ring in front of people and not run. The walk to the ring is the whole program compressed into 30 meters.

WHAT HAPPENS

Every story your mind tells about who you are gets tested in that walk. The person who walks in is the person you've been building for 55 days. Walk.

EVENING WRITE

"What did I find when I walked into the ring? Who was I in that moment? Was that person different from who I thought I was?"

DAYS 56–57

Chiang Mai → Medellín

TRANSIT

DEBRIEF + TRAVEL TO COLOMBIA

DAY 56 — DEBRIEF

Write the full Muay Thai chapter: "Who arrived at camp? What did the ring show them? What dies when you can't perform safety? What lives?" This is one of the most important writes of the program. Take the time it deserves.

GOODBYE

Say goodbye to your trainers properly. Tell them specifically what they showed you. Name it. Let them receive it.

DAY 57 — TRAVEL

Long travel day to Medellín. Use the flight — read, write, sleep. You are leaving Encounter and entering Return. Everything you found now gets given away.

MONTH THREE · DAYS 58–90 · PHASE 3: RETURN

Colombia + Costa Rica

Medellín · Coffee Region · Colombian Amazon · Costa Rica

> *"What did I find? Who does it belong to? What do I build now?"*

DURATION	PHASE	PRIMARY THEME	CAPSTONE
33 Days	Return	Service, Leadership, Building	7-Day Prototype Program

WEEKS 9–10

Colombia

"What does a person look like who refused to be defined by their story?"

DAYS 58–60

Medellín, Colombia

ENCOUNTER

MEDELLÍN — THE CITY THAT REBUILT ITSELF

DAY 58 – ARRIVAL

Arrive Medellín. Take the cable car to the comunas — the hillside neighborhoods that were the epicenter of the violence. Stand there. Look at the city below. Read about what happened here and what they chose to build instead. Let the story land.

DAY 59 – PARAGLIDING

Paraglide from San Félix. The Andes valley opens beneath you and the city is tiny — the city that was the most dangerous in the world, small beneath your feet. Afternoon: walk the real city. El Centro, the Metrocable barrios, the Botero Plaza. Talk to people. Ask about their city.

DAY 60 – ROCK CLIMBING

Real rock climbing with local climbers — not expats, people who climb because it's their life. Your Muay Thai has built physical confidence you didn't have before. The wall is a conversation between you and the rock. You ask with your hands. It answers.

THE PURPOSE

Colombia is chosen because it is a country that refused to be defined by its lowest moment. You have been stripped, challenged, and rebuilt. Now you come to a place that did the same thing at national scale. The question: "What story am I refusing to be defined by? What am I building instead?"

DAYS 61–63

Medellín Youth Programs

SERVICE

YOUTH SERVICE — THREE DAYS OF SHOWING UP

DAY 61 — EARN TRUST

Find a Medellín youth movement program (Corpoarte, Somos Identidad, or similar) — contact before arriving. Show up. Run morning movement sessions: warm-up, drill, challenge, debrief circle. You are new. Earn trust. What matters is not the activity — it is whether they feel your presence.

DAY 62 — COME BACK

Return. The return is where trust is built. Anyone can show up once. Ask the coordinator what they actually need — not what feels good to offer, but what they actually need. Then provide it.

DAY 63 — MAKE YOURSELF REDUNDANT

Leave them something concrete — a workout structure they can run themselves. Don't make yourself necessary. Make yourself redundant. That's the measure of real teaching. That's the measure of service.

DAYS 65–67

Eje Cafetero

ENCOUNTER

COFFEE REGION — 5 AM WITH THE FARMERS

THREE DAYS ON A FINCA

Not a coffee tour. A working farm. Wake at 5 AM with the farmers. Walk the rows before sunrise. Help with whatever the season requires. Physical, repetitive work with your hands. Bike the mountain roads in the afternoon.

THE LESSON

These people wake before dawn not because they're disciplined, but because the work matters and the rhythm is theirs. That combination — meaningful work and personal rhythm — is what you've been searching for. What would you wake before dawn for?

EVENING WRITE

"What matters enough in my life to wake up for? What would I do before dawn not because I have to, but because it's mine?"

DAYS 68–70

Colombian Amazon

JUNGLE

AMAZON — SMALLNESS WITHOUT FEAR

TRAVEL + ARRIVAL

Fly to Leticia. Everything changes. The air is different. The sound is different. There is no city sound — only the river and the jungle and animals you cannot name. Travel by river boat to a small Ticuna indigenous community. This is not an eco-lodge. This is someone's home.

THE EXPERIENCE

Dawn river fishing. Jungle walk with a guide whose knowledge of this place is 500 years deep. Two hours alone at the river's edge. The Amazon gives you one specific feeling nothing else on this trip will: smallness without fear. You are one creature among millions in an ecosystem that does not require you. And it makes you feel, paradoxically, more real.

EVENING WRITE

"What does it feel like to not be the most important thing in the room? What does the Amazon know about living that I can carry home?"

DAY 71

In Transit

THE LETTER

THE SECOND LETTER — WHO ARE YOU NOW?

TRAVEL + WRITING

Return to Leticia. Fly toward Costa Rica. On the plane: write the second letter. "Who did I think I was when I left home? Who am I now?" Seal it with the New Zealand letter. You open both on Day 85. Not before. The two letters together will be the most important documents of this entire program.

WHAT THE LETTER ASKS

Not just events — the change. Not just what happened — who changed. Be specific about what died, what was born, what you now know that you did not know when you left.

INSTRUCTION

Seal it. Place it with the NZ letter. Label it "OPEN ON DAY 85 WITH THE FIRST LETTER."

WEEKS 11–12

Costa Rica — Build + Give

"What do I have? Who needs it? How do I give it?"

DAYS 72–76

La Fortuna · Pacuare · Pacific

PHYSICAL

FINAL PHYSICAL SYNTHESIS — NOTICE WHAT CHANGED

DAY 72 – VOLCANO

Hike Arenal Volcano — active, steaming, surrounded by jungle. The earth alive in a way impossible to ignore.

DAY 73 – PACUARE RIVER

Rio Pacuare — one of the top 10 white water rivers in the world. Class IV. Notice the difference between who you were on the Shotover River in Week 3 and who you are now. Physical challenge is information. What does your body know that it didn't 73 days ago?

DAYS 74–76

Canyoneering into waterfalls · Pacific coast surfing and freediving · Rest and reflection. Write: "What can I do now that I couldn't do 76 days ago? Not skills — capacity. Who have I become?"

DAYS 77–83

Costa Rica

WRITING WEEK

THE WRITING WEEK — BUILD THE WORLD SCHOOL

DAY 77 — OPEN THE LETTERS

Open both letters — New Zealand and Colombia. Read them slowly. Let the distance between who wrote them and who is reading them land fully. Don't rush this moment. You earned it over 77 days.

DAYS 78–81 — WRITE

Day 78: the founding document — write to the 17-year-old in class right now who feels the gap. Tell them what you found, what it cost, what it gave you. Day 79: the framework document. Day 80: the recruitment pitch. Day 81: the service philosophy.

DAYS 82–83 — LAUNCH

Day 82: reach out to people you met over 82 days. Message them — "I'm running a 7-day experience in Costa Rica next week." Charge $500–800 per person. This is the first sale of the world school. Day 83: prepare everything for the prototype program.

> THE PURPOSE
>
> *The writing week is not administrative. It is the act of turning experience into transmission. What you went through is only as valuable as your ability to offer it to someone else. This week you build that bridge.*

DAYS 84–90

The Prototype

The World School — Version 1.0. Five to eight people. Seven days. Everything you lived, compressed into a form others can step into.

DAY 84
DAY ONE

Arrival — The Question

Participants arrive. No phones in the first circle. Opening question: *"What story about yourself are you most tired of carrying?"* — Let silence land after each answer. Don't fill it. The silence is the first thing you give them. Evening: cold plunge together. Brief them on the daily rhythm. Morning pages start at 6 AM tomorrow.

DAY 85
DAY TWO

The Body

Group cold plunge at dawn. Morning pages — first time for most of them. Physical challenge day — hike, river swim, something that pushes them. Individual check-ins: *"What came up in the hike? What did your mind say when it got hard?"* Evening circle: *"What does your body know about you that your mind tries to hide?"*

DAY 86
DAY THREE

Service

Organized through a local Costa Rican youth organization. You bring the group to work with local young people — a morning movement session, a game, a real conversation. You design it. You lead it. You hold the space. Debrief: *"What happened to you when you were responsible for someone else's experience?"*

DAY 87
DAY FOUR

Adrenaline + Honesty

Canyoneering — rappelling into waterfalls, swimming through canyons. Something that requires complete presence. Watch who shows up when they can't perform calm. Key debrief: *"What does the moment before a jump tell you about who you are?"* One-on-one conversations in the evening: *"What are you not saying yet?"*

DAY 88
DAY FIVE

Solo

Each participant spends 4 hours alone in nature. No phone. No agenda. Just being. Some will love it. Some will panic. Both are information. Evening circle: *"What came up in the silence?*

What does your own company feel like?" This is always the most powerful circle of the week.

DAY 89
DAY SIX

Create

Each person creates something — a letter, a drawing, a manifesto, a movement piece, anything. It matters that it's real. That it reflects who they actually are, not who they perform being. Afternoon: each person shares what they made. You witness. You don't evaluate. There is a difference between those two things.

DAY 90
DAY SEVEN

The Closing

Final cold plunge as a group. Final morning pages. Closing circle — each person answers three questions, you answer last: *"Who did you arrive as? Who are you leaving as? What are you doing differently?"* After the last person speaks, hold one full minute of silence. Let everything that happened in seven days be real. Then close it. The world school has begun.

FINANCIAL BREAKDOWN

What It Costs. What It Returns.

BUDGET VERSION

$17,300

Full 90 days — all activities, accommodation, flights, gear, emergency fund. Budget version, done smart.

COMFORTABLE VERSION

$26,500

More flexibility, better accommodation, buffer for unexpected opportunities.

NET AFTER RECOVERY

~$12k

After prototype income ($4,200+) and work-trade savings. Less than one semester at most US universities.

Personal Program Costs

Flights (multi-city)	$3,200–4,500
Accommodation (90 nights)	$2,800–4,500
Food (90 days)	$2,100–3,200
Muay Thai Camp (14 days, all-in)	$900–1,400
Freediving AIDA Course	$450–650
NZ Adrenaline (bungee, skydive, etc.)	$1,800–3,000
Paragliding, rafting, climbing, more	$700–1,500
Travel insurance (90 days, adventure)	$500–800
Gear (pack, water, first aid, wetsuit)	$800–1,400
Vaccines + health prep	$350–500

Cost Recovery

Prototype program (7 × $600)	+$4,200
Work-trade surf hostel stays	+$800–1,200
Content / brand partnerships (Month 3+)	Variable

World School Model

Per cohort revenue (8 × $17,500)	$140,000
Costs (guides, flights, activities)	~$75,000
Gross margin per cohort	~$65,000
Two cohorts per year	~$130,000

Year 1: Do the trip. Document. Run prototype. Cost: ~$13–17k
Year 2: First paid cohort. Break-even to

Emergency fund (non-negotiable)	$2,500–3,000
Total Range	**$17,300–26,500**

profitable.

Year 3: Two cohorts + guide training. Sustainable.

WHAT COMES AFTER

The World School

THE GAP begins as one person's story and becomes something larger when others recognize themselves in it. Every person who completes this program carries the question forward. Every person who guides a cohort multiplies the depth.

YEAR ONE

The Story

You lived it. You documented it. You ran the prototype. You have 90 days of content, a founding document, and proof of concept. Build the story. It is the marketing, the curriculum, and the enrollment.

YEAR TWO

The Cohort

First full cohort — 6 to 10 people, 90 days, your program. You partner with the local guides you spent 3 months meeting. They become the infrastructure. You become the architect.

YEAR THREE

The School

You train other guides to run versions of this program. THE GAP scales not by losing depth but by multiplying the number of people who carry the depth. A movement, not a company.

"You know that feeling — like you're living someone else's life? Like school taught you everything except who you actually are?

THE GAP is 90 days to find out. Movement, challenge, masters, deserts, oceans, silence, service. Three countries. Three phases.

One question at the center of all of it:

Who are you when the noise stops?"

THE GAP

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